



Cambridge (CIE) IGCSE English Language



Your notes

Question 3: Extended Response

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Your notes

How to Answer Question 3: Extended Response

How to Answer Question 3: Extended Response

Paper 1: Reading is the compulsory exam in your IGCSE, and CIE examiners recommend that you complete the questions in the order they are set. By the time you reach Question 3, you should already be familiar with **Text C**, upon which this question is based.

The following guide will provide you with the information you need to answer **Question 3: Extended response** with confidence.

Overview

For this task, you will be asked to produce a piece of writing in a particular format, based on what you have read in Text C. You may be asked to write in one of six possible formats (genres):

- A letter
- A report
- A journal entry
- A speech
- An interview
- An article

You are advised to write about 250 to 350 words, which means between one and one and a half sides of A4 in standard handwriting. There are 25 marks available for this extended response: up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 10 marks are available for the quality of your writing. You are being tested on both reading and writing assessment objectives, as follows:

15 marks:

- **R1**: demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings
- **R2**: demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes
- **R3**: analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text

10 marks:

- **W1**: articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined
- **W2**: organise and structure ideas and opinions for deliberate effect
- **W3**: use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context

- **W4:** use register appropriate to context
- **W5:** make accurate use of spelling, punctuation and grammar

This means, in order to get the highest marks, you need to:

- Select appropriate ideas from the text
- Develop them relevantly, demonstrating your thorough evaluation and analysis of the text
- Support what you write with details from the text
- Write in an appropriate style and tone for the genre (format)
- Write a clear, well-sequenced and balanced response which covers the three areas of the question
- Write in your own words, sounding confident and consistent

Breaking down the question

Question 3 is quite detailed. It is therefore important that you read the whole of the question and instructions carefully. You should highlight the key information you have given, and start by annotating the text for information that answers each of the three bullet points in the question.

For example (taken from the June 2022 exam paper):



Your notes



Re-read **Text C, *What it's like to be married to a future Ironman***, in the insert and then answer **Question 3** on this question paper.

Question 3

You are Sam. After completing the race you are interviewed for a podcast about your experience and the advice you would offer to anyone thinking of entering an Ironman.

The interviewer asks you three questions only:

- How exactly do you need to prepare for a challenge like Ironman **and** why is each aspect of that preparation important?
- How do you think preparing for Ironman affected other areas of your life **and** what advice would you offer anyone considering entering an Ironman for the first time?
- What were the rewards of completing an Ironman for you and your family?

Write the words of the interview.

Base your interview on what you have read in **Text C**, but be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullet points.

Begin your interview with the first question.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 10 marks for the quality of your writing.

This gives you the scenario

You need to address all three bullet points in your response

This tells you what format to write your answer in

Make sure you have read these instructions carefully

Steps to success

Following these steps will give you a strategy for answering this question effectively:

1. Read the question and **highlight**:

- The important information in the scenario (in the above example, you are asked to imagine that you are Sam, *not* the writer)
- The format you are being asked to write in (letter, speech, article, etc.)
- The important information from each of the three bullet points that you need to include in your answer

2. Re-read Text C and annotate any references directly relevant to the focus of the first bullet point:

- Do the same for the second and third bullet points *before* you start writing your answer

3. Start your answer with the first bullet point:

- Maintain your focus on the bullet point – avoid the temptation to write about everything or make up information not directly relevant to the bullet point

4. Ensure you write in the format instructed:

- This means that if you are being asked to write up an interview, then you need to use language and a tone appropriate for this style of writing
- You can use the three bullet points as sub-headings, if appropriate

5. Ensure you leave time to edit and correct your response

You are advised to spend no more than 40 minutes on this question (including reading time).

Exam tips

- Always remember to base your answer on the ideas and details you find in Text C:
 - If you write your answer without any reference to Text C, you will score very low marks
- Keep the intended audience and purpose of writing in mind throughout your answer:
 - Maintain a consistent voice and style throughout
- Do not invent extra information or details outside of what you read in Text C:
 - Look for clues and evidence in the text to help you make informed judgements about characters and situations
- Give equal attention to each of the three bullet points
- Do not copy directly from the text:
 - You need to use your own words as far as possible to express your ideas
- Avoid just repeating details of what happens in the text:
 - Try to develop your ideas by explaining feelings or commenting from the point of view of the character you are writing as

The full June 2022 exam paper is available [here](#).

For more advice on how to apply the skills required for success in this question, please see our [Question 3 skills: Extended response to reading](#) revision notes.



Your notes



Your notes

Question 3 Skills: Extended Response to Reading

Question 3 Skills: Extended Response to Reading

For this task, you will be asked to produce a piece of writing in a particular format, based on what you have read in Text C. You may be asked to write in one of six possible formats (genres):

- A letter
- A report
- A journal entry
- A speech
- An interview
- An article

There are 25 marks available for this extended response: up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 10 marks are available for the quality of your writing. The following guide will cover the main skills you need to demonstrate in order to answer this question successfully.

Selecting and developing details from a text

This task will require you to produce a piece of writing based on the ideas and specific details you find in Text C. However, this does not mean just “re-telling” the text, quoting directly from the passage or repeating the details. You are being assessed on your ability to select relevant information from the text and then develop these details in the style of writing instructed. Importantly, this means that you should use clues and evidence in the text to help you make judgements about characters and situations, and then creatively expand on the details selected.

Your starting point will always be the bullet points in the question. These tell you what to focus on, and what you should highlight on Text C. Let’s look at the following example, about a student tour of the ancient Greek site of Delphi.

Imagine that you are one of the students who visited Delphi. It is the evening of your visit and you have now returned to Athens.

Write a letter to your parents, telling them about your experiences so far.

In your letter you should include the following points:

- Details of your trip and your feelings about it before you visited Delphi
- Your thoughts and feelings about the visit to Delphi and about how your teacher reacted to it

- What you have learnt from your trip so far and why you would (or would not) recommend your parents to make a similar visit

In this example, the task tells you to write from the point of view of a student on the tour, and the first bullet point indicates that you need to find details about the trip and the student's feelings about it before visiting Delphi.

Let's find this information in the first part of the passage. The narrator of the passage is the teacher (not the student), so we are going to need to use **inference** to work out information about the trip and the student's feelings about it.



Your notes

Text	Relevant details
I took a look at my students and wondered if we should cancel the day trip to Delphi. We had been touring for seven days non-stop with every morning an early one; the students were visibly exhausted. Today I was tempted to give us all a break. We had already visited many of the ancient sites of Greece and Rome and we still had a week to go. Surely, we could skip Delphi, a site I was only vaguely familiar with, without causing undue harm to the students' education? I knew they had wished for more time to hang out in the city, and the three-hour drive each way to Delphi and back sounded gruelling. "Could we just stay here today?" I asked our guide, careful to stay out of earshot of the students. "Sure." He frowned. "But I think you should go." I didn't want to disappoint him. "OK, then," I said, "We're going." After all, it seemed unfair to deny the interested ones in the group the trek to Delphi. "It'll be fine," I said, trying to convince myself as well as the students. "You can sleep on the bus."	- Touring for seven days non-stop - Early mornings - Students visibly exhausted - Even the teacher was tempted to give everyone a break - Already visited many of the ancient sites of Greece and Rome - Still had a week to go - Not that familiar with Delphi - Students wanted more time to hang out in the city - Three-hour drive each way to Delphi

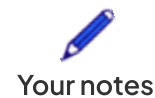


Your notes

	- Teacher didn't want to disappoint the guide - Some of the students wanted to go - Teacher thinks a solution is for the students to sleep on the bus
--	---

Next, we need to “develop” those relevant details within the scope of the passage, and from the point of view of the “student”.

Details	Development
Touring for seven days non-stop/early mornings/students visibly exhausted	We were completely worn out. The trip so far had consisted of constant travelling with no down time whatsoever, and we hadn't had a lie in all week. I know this seems hard to believe, but we've been up at 6am every morning!
Even the teacher was tempted to give everyone a break	Our teacher could see we were flagging, and we were hoping he would give us a bit of a break
Already visited many of the ancient sites of Greece and Rome/still had a week to go	We'd trekked around ancient monuments, crumbling temples and dusty ruins all week and we still had another week of ancient history to take in. It's all been very interesting, but there are only so many mosaic floors to see
Not that familiar with Delphi	I wouldn't mind, but who has even heard of Delphi? It's hardly one of the more famous sites. I don't think our education is going to suffer massively if we miss it out
Students wanted more time to hang out in the city/three-hour drive each way to Delphi	The city, however, is amazing! So many excellent shops and little cafes. Most of us wanted a bit of time to go shopping, and I really wanted to get you a lovely handmade tablecloth, as they are really pretty. It's a three-hour drive each way to Delphi, so that would take away any time we might have had for shopping and sightseeing



Teacher didn't want to disappoint the guide/some of the students wanted to go/teacher thinks a solution is for the students to sleep on the bus	But there were a couple in our group who really, really wanted to see Delphi, and I got the impression that our teacher didn't want to disappoint our guide. So his brilliant solution was to sleep on the bus. This site had better be worth the effort!
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Each development point takes the relevant details from the passage and uses logical inferences, based on the information in the passage, to expand on the ideas in the student's "voice". The idea of a **narrative voice** will be explored further in the following section.

Language and tone

In order to be successful in this task, you also need to use a register appropriate for the format of writing. This means adapting your tone, language and expression to make it appropriate for its intended context. It is therefore important that you identify the point of view from which you are writing and stick to it throughout your answer (and to be aware that you may not be writing as the original "speaker" in the text).

This is your narrative voice. You are expected to mirror the attitude of the character in the text in your response, and maintain this voice and style consistently. In the above example, you are writing as a student writing a letter to their parents. In this case, it would be appropriate to be a bit less formal and to use some appropriate **colloquialisms**.

Your language and tone are how you convey the format you have been asked to write in. There are six possible formats you may be given in the exam:

- A letter
- A report
- A journal entry
- A speech
- An interview
- An article

However, as more marks are available for meeting the reading assessment objectives than the writing ones, it is important not to concern yourself with the layout details of the different styles of writing. It's a good idea to start a letter with "Dear..." and signing off appropriately, and you should use the bullet points given in the task as "questions" if you have to write an interview, but it is not necessary to use headings, taglines or subheadings for the other formats.

While your choice of register will largely be dictated by the task and the character you are being asked to write as, the following guidelines are always helpful:



Your notes

Type of writing	Form, language and tone
Letter	- It's important to use an appropriate greeting and sign off - The level of formality will be dependent on who you are writing to (your intended audience) - Write in the first person ("I", "my", etc.) - There is no need to include an address or date
Report	- This could be a newspaper report, or a report on an event - Generally, the tone will be more formal and detached - It will probably be written from a third-person perspective - No need to use headings
Journal entry	- This type of writing will always be personal and based on feeling and experience - It will be written in the first person ("I", "my", etc.) - The language will be more informal
Speech	- This type of writing may use persuasive techniques - It will be written in the first person ("I", "my", etc.), but will address the audience directly ("you") - The language of a speech tends to be friendly and relatable
Interview	- You should use the bullet points in the task as the three interview questions - Write your answers to the questions as the character you have been asked to write as - The language and tone will be quite personal, based on experience and feeling
Article	- This format will normally be a magazine article - It could be written from a first-person ("I", "my", etc.) or a third-person perspective - The language and tone will be more formal, suitable for a printed publication

For model answers for each of the above formats, please see the following guides:

- [Question 3 Model Answer: Letter](#)
- [Question 3 Model Answer: Report](#)
- [Question 3 Model Answer: Journal](#)
- [Question 3 Model Answer: Speech](#)
- [Question 3 Model Answer: Interview](#)
- [Question 3 Model Answer: Article](#)



Your notes

Rewriting a Text

This is where your **Question** tool from your **Critical Reading Tools** comes in handy, so you can ask: **who, what, where, when, why**:

Who are you writing as?

So what **Role** are you taking on

What are you writing about?

What are the key **facts** from the text and what is the **purpose** of the writing?

Where has it taken place?

Imagine yourself in the scene.

When did it happen?

If it's not clear, then you can always make that part up!

Why is this being written?

Who will be reading this and what sort of **audience** are you writing for?

How should you format your answer?

What form should your writing be in? It will tell you in the question so make sure you layout the answer correctly.



Your notes

Question 3 Model Answer: Letter

Question 3 Model Answer: Letter

For this task, you will be asked to produce a piece of writing in a particular format, based on what you have read in Text C. You may be asked to write in one of six possible formats (genres):

- A letter
- A report
- A journal entry
- A speech
- An interview
- An article

The following guide will demonstrate how to answer Question 3 in the format of a **letter**. The task itself is taken from a past exam paper.

Text C and Question 3

The following Text C example is about two men embarking on a journey across the desert.



Your notes

In 1935, two men, Max (the narrator) and Helmuth, try to find a land route from India to China. Here, Max describes part of their journey from the Judaeen Desert in the Middle East and across the River Jordan.

We set off on our desert journey the following day in good spirits, and full of high expectations. The car glided through the gorges of Judaea over bubbling hot asphalt until a sign-board in Arabic, Hebrew and English proclaimed the words 'Sea Level'. The way descended another 400 metres and it was a peculiar feeling to know that all the water in all the oceans of the world was towering above you like mountains.

5

In front of us lay the leaden expanse of the Dead Sea. Was it true that it was impossible to sink in it? I tried for myself while Helmuth looked on and smiled. You lie on top of the water, motionless, like a cork. Swimming in the conventional sense is not possible, since hands and feet flail around in the air like useless paddles. According to the brochures, one could 'read a newspaper undisturbed or hold up a sunshade'. A local photographer lurked nearby.

10

However, reading a newspaper in comfort is just a publicity stunt. After only a few minutes the salt begins to affect you. You itch and burn in every pore and I wanted nothing else than to get into the River Jordan double-quick and rinse the salt crust off. Helmuth laughed as I urged him to put his foot down on the accelerator.

15

We crossed the Jordan by bridge. This was where Asia really began.



Your notes

The track leading up out of the Dead Sea depression, along the slopes of the Jordan valley, was stony and steep. We had to get over a high point of 1200 metres in the mountains. The May sun blazed fiercely and the engine laboured its way up in first gear. The radiator thermometer was already showing over 90 degrees. 20

'This car is far too heavy,' I eventually admitted.

Helmuth nodded silently. 'I did warn you, Max.'

Out of the corner of my eye I could see anxiety in his face, and I bit my lip controlling an urge to point out that most of our luggage was his, packed lovingly by his mother before we started out. The overloaded car springs were groaning on the bumpy road. 25

100 degrees. The radiator boiled and whistled. I stopped the car. Helmuth dug out our map of Asia. 'Here's Palestine and there's China,' he said. 'We've come about 400 km so far, and there are about 23 000 still to go.'

We sat there for a long time brooding, side by side, with the big map of Asia on our knees. We were both depressed but understood the need not to let this turn into recrimination. 30

Our weight was at the root of our whole problem. 'We'll have to downsize,' I said. 'We'll have to jettison some of our luggage.'

Helmuth nodded silently, staring at the boxes in the rear of the car.

'Maybe we can manage with them as far as Baghdad,' I offered, 'and they can be put into storage.' 35

Easier in our minds, we waited for darkness to fall before we drove on. Night journeys are not only cooler but are beautiful in the East. Over the landscape arched a sky sparkling with a plethora of stars. Along the rocks of the gorge huddled flocks of storks, shining like patches of snow as the light danced on their plumage. I wished I'd brought a better camera. The birds were not alarmed, being tired from their long journey. They had come from the Sudan, and the next day they would fly on to their northern kingdom and the European springtime. A few of them raised their heads sleepily from their feathers and followed us with the long, serious gaze of philosophers. Perhaps they were thinking, 'Funny these humans going south just now.' 40 45

At eleven o'clock we gratefully pitched camp. Sleeping on camp beds in the open with the gentle warm breezes caressing our faces was wonderful.

Question 3:



Your notes

Imagine you are Helmuth from **Text C**. Straight after the evening that you and Max pitch camp, you write a letter to your mother.

In your letter you should comment on:

- the most enjoyable parts of your journey so far **and** why they were enjoyable
- the challenges you and Max faced **and** how you overcame these challenges
- the problems you foresee for the rest of the trip **and** how you might have been better prepared for them.

Write the words of your letter.

Base your letter on what you have read in **Text C**, but be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullets.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 10 marks for the quality of your writing.

Question 3 letter model answer

Based on the above question, the following model answer is an example of a full-mark letter response.



Your notes

The answer starts by demonstrating understanding of the format of the writing and contextualises the letter in relation to Text C

Dear Mother,

I am writing to you from my camp bed in the middle of the desert, underneath a sky sparkling with stars. There is a gentle warm breeze making the temperature most pleasant to write in, and I wanted to convey to you our adventures so far.

Each bullet point in the question is dealt with in a separate paragraph

Our journey so far has had many enjoyable moments. We set off through the Judean Desert in good spirits and full of high expectations, and as our car literally glided over bubbling hot asphalt we experienced the exotic novelty of being 400 metres below sea level. It was a strange feeling to think that we were travelling at the same depth as creatures of the deep. I was also curious to see the Dead Sea as I had heard so much about it, and it really did live up to expectations. Max promptly tried it out for himself, lying on top of the water like a cork while I looked on, smiling at the inevitable salt burn that would follow. After a quick dip in the River Jordan to wash off the salt crust, I chuckled as he urged me to speed away as fast as our car would allow! Crossing the Jordan by bridge does not lend itself to acceleration, although I believe Max thought that I was driving slowly on purpose.

The answer uses information directly from the text, and then develops it

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Your notes

The response shows understanding of the task and who the narrative voice is supposed to be

As we crossed into Asia, I found the night journey to be not only more comfortable but stunningly beautiful. At one point we saw flocks of storks, taking a rest from their migration, the light dancing on their feathers. However, I also have to say that crossing into Asia also brought with it fresh challenges for Max and me. The terrain became steep, stony and bumpy - a definite contrast with the smooth sailing we experienced in the earlier part of our journey. The sun blazed fiercely and our car began to struggle. I began to feel anxious about whether the engine would make it, especially as I had already warned Max about the amount of weight we were carrying (although I silently knew that most of the luggage was mine, lovingly packed by you). As the thermometer hit 100 degrees, Max stopped the car as the radiator boiled and whistled. I got out the map and we considered our options, especially as we still had about 23,000km to go. Eventually, I reluctantly agreed that we needed to remove some of the weight, but hoped we could make it as far as Baghdad where we could put some of the luggage into storage, rather than throwing our luggage out into the desert!

The style and tone of the letter is appropriate to the time period and intended recipient

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Your notes

So, after a very long day, I can now reflect somewhat on the problems I foresee for the rest of the trip and how we might have been better prepared for them. One of the biggest immediate issues is whether the car is able to make it to Baghdad; in these remote areas, it is easy to get lost, and coupled with the intense heat, we are pushing our vehicle to its limits. In addition, if we cannot locate reasonable luggage storage, I anticipate some emotional strain between me and Max, although one hopes we might be able to avoid recriminations and thus continue our trip. It may have helped if we had versed ourselves better in the local languages before our trip, or at least brought along some bilingual dictionaries, and definitely not believed everything sold to us in travel brochures! We may have started out with a sense of false optimism, but let us hope that we do not encounter too many more problems on the rest of our journey.

With warm wishes,

Helmuth

The narrative voice and perspective is sustained throughout the response

The greeting and sign off are appropriate for a letter format

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Unannotated model answer

Model answer:

Dear Mother,

I am writing to you from my camp bed in the middle of the desert, underneath a sky sparkling with stars. There is a gentle warm breeze making the temperature most pleasant to write in, and I wanted to convey to you our adventures so far.

Our journey so far has had many enjoyable moments. We set off through the Judaeen Desert in good spirits and full of high expectations, and as our car literally glided over bubbling hot asphalt we experienced the exotic novelty of being 400 metres below sea level. It was a strange feeling to think that we were travelling at the same depth as creatures of the deep. I was also curious to see the Dead Sea as I had heard so much about it, and it really did live up to expectations. Max promptly tried it out for himself, lying on top of the water like a cork while I looked on, smiling at the inevitable salt burn that would follow. After a quick dip in the River Jordan to wash off the salt crust, I chuckled as he urged me to speed away as fast as our car would allow! Crossing the Jordan by bridge does not lend itself to acceleration, although I believe Max thought that I was driving slowly on purpose.



Your notes

As we crossed into Asia, I found the night journey to be not only more comfortable but stunningly beautiful. At one point we saw flocks of storks, taking a rest from their migration, the light dancing on their feathers. However, I also have to say that crossing into Asia also brought with it fresh challenges for Max and me. The terrain became steep, stony and bumpy – a definite contrast with the smooth sailing we experienced in the earlier part of our journey. The sun blazed fiercely and our car began to struggle. I began to feel anxious about whether the engine would make it, especially as I had already warned Max about the amount of weight we were carrying (although I silently knew that most of the luggage was mine, lovingly packed by you). As the thermometer hit 100 degrees, Max stopped the car as the radiator boiled and whistled. I got out the map and we considered our options, especially as we still had about 23,000km to go. Eventually, I reluctantly agreed that we needed to remove some of the weight, but hoped we could make it as far as Baghdad where we could put some of the luggage into storage, rather than throwing our luggage out into the desert!

So, after a very long day, I can now reflect somewhat on the problems I foresee for the rest of the trip and how we might have been better prepared for them. One of the biggest immediate issues is whether the car is able to make it to Baghdad; in these remote areas, it is easy to get lost, and coupled with the intense heat, we are pushing our vehicle to its limits. In addition, if we cannot locate reasonable luggage storage, I anticipate some emotional strain between me and Max, although one hopes we might be able to avoid recriminations and thus continue our trip. It may have helped if we had versed ourselves better in the local languages before our trip, or at least brought along some bilingual dictionaries, and definitely not believed everything sold to us in travel brochures! We may have started out with a sense of false optimism, but let us hope that we do not encounter too many more problems on the rest of our journey.

With warm wishes,

Helmuth

Commentary:

- The answer starts by demonstrating understanding of the format of the writing and contextualises the letter in relation to Text C
- Each bullet point in the question is dealt with in a separate paragraph
- The answer uses information directly from the text, and then develops it
- The response shows understanding of the task and who the narrative voice is supposed to be
- The style and tone of the letter is appropriate to the time period and the intended recipient
- The narrative voice and perspective is sustained throughout the response
- The greeting and sign off are appropriate for a letter format





Your notes

Examiner Tips and Tricks

The suggested word count for this task is a guide, and you are not penalised for writing under or over 250–350 words. However, writing too little can mean that your answer does not have enough development or detail. Writing too much can mean that you go off topic and lose focus, which again can be self-penalising. It is therefore a good idea to stick as closely as you can to the word count guidance.

Our model answers are not written in timed, exam conditions. We have therefore shown a range of points that could be included to answer this question, and provided a model you can use to help with the structure of your answer.

You can find further guidance on suggested word counts for CIE [here](#).

Summary

- Remember to read the question carefully and highlight:
 - The instructions (what you have to do)
 - The focus of each bullet point
- Re-read Text C and highlight the relevant information you can use in your answer
- Address each bullet point in order:
 - Make sure you cover all of the bullet points as equally as possible
 - Base all of your answer on the ideas and details you find in Text C
- Decide on the voice and style you want to create and maintain that in your answer
- Do not just repeat details of what happened:
 - You need to develop your ideas to demonstrate understanding



Your notes

Question 3 Model Answer: Report

Question 3 Model Answer: Report

For this task, you will be asked to produce a piece of writing in a particular format, based on what you have read in Text C. You may be asked to write in one of six possible formats (genres):

- A letter
- A report
- A journal entry
- A speech
- An interview
- An article

The following guide will demonstrate how to answer Question 3 in the format of a **report**. The task itself is taken from a past exam paper.

Text and question

The following text is about a narrator and his friend, Royer, going on a fishing trip together.

The narrator and his friend Royer are going on their first fishing trip together in years. The two men have not seen each other since university, and have both married and had families in the meantime. Their proposed destination is White Cap River – the setting of Royer's favourite childhood adventure story and somewhere neither has visited before.

People spend hours packing to go fishing, engaged in a kind of military manoeuvre, gear piled strategically and checklists in hand. On the eve of our campaign, I just made sure I'd packed a rod and reel, confident that comrade Royer would have invested heavily in a car-boot full of flashy state-of-the-art equipment as always. On the morning of our departure, Royer, a little rounder than I remembered, pulled up at my house in a bottom-of-the-range soft-top sports car he'd borrowed for our trip. Surprised to find ample space for my gear, I unearthed a faded atlas from the car boot, innocently imagining the pleasures of the long drive ahead.

The sky, unseasonably cloudless and omen-less when we set out, stretched out beyond the suburbs and responsibilities, moving into farming country and onto the highway. The camera lens of life was opening before my eyes, delivering more space and light, exposing an astounding panorama ahead. We coasted through rolling hills, past fragrant wild grasses surfed by the breeze. The car, echoing with tinny music, transported us back in time. 'What a fine planet!' I thought.

Unexpectedly, the road turned upward, clinging to the sides of a mountain. A series of hairpin bends afforded some impressive views of the valley below. Royer, now in the passenger seat, looked suddenly uncomfortable. He fidgeted and glanced the other way, emitting a strange yipping noise, until we descended in the afternoon back into the National Forest.



Your notes

After a leisurely late lunch, we checked out a local fishing-tackle shop. The lonely clerk appeared to be surprised by the sight of potential customers, but eventually freed himself from his chair. When I asked how far White Cap River was he looked quizzical, answering, 'About 15 minutes from here to the old road into the canyon.' He assured us that the fish there were likely to be in excellent shape.

'And from there?'

'Another hour.'

'That can't be right,' disputed Royer, searching for his spectacles. 'The canyon road's only eight kilometres on my map.'

'You got a four-wheel drive vehicle?' asked the clerk.

'Not exactly,' I told him, glancing outside when he did.

'Well, you'll probably make it.'

We found the canyon road without trouble – fifteen minutes as the clerk predicted.

The road had trickled down to a ribbon of cement-hard dirt, rutted and rough on the tyres. It wormed its way through forest land, slithering between the tall trees, obscuring our view. Royer, at the wheel, seemed utterly miserable, inching forwards cautiously, until we rounded one last bend, the trees fell away, and we were confronted by the magnificent pit of the great canyon below. Way at the bottom of this geological miracle, glittering like the tiniest trace of quicksilver, was the river.



Your notes

An hour away? More like six hours at the rate Royer was driving and yipping. He was sweating now. His face drained of blood.

His yipping got louder as the crumbling road downwards narrowed still further. In minutes, it was scarcely wide enough for one car, much less two should anybody come driving up from below – if anyone ever had survived the drive down. The cliffs were sheer. The phrase ‘margin for error’ was meaningless. In the end it was too much for him. He froze.

‘You drive,’ he said, breathing hard.

I replaced him. What else could I do? When you’ve known a man for 30 years you’d figure you’d be aware of his phobias, but I certainly never knew. I released the brake and moved forwards but Royer trembled so violently as the incline steepened, I caught his phobia like flu and almost yipped myself.

‘You want to turn around?’ I asked, redundantly.

‘Might be good,’ he said.

Instead, we spent our waning daylight hours and remaining fuel searching for a less dangerous route to the water, finding eventually an unmarked roadway winding downwards at an almost reasonable tilt. It stopped just in sight of the river, which we now saw was foaming with whitecaps so big that we’d need a serious boat to fish it. The sky was almost dark too.

We surrendered sheepishly to a miserable night in the car without blankets or proper food, wondering if we could possibly be those same bold fellows of our youth – back then nothing had seemed daunting.

In the morning, our failure didn’t sit well with us. Despite greying clouds overhead, once more we felt ourselves filling up with the oxygen of blind faith. Royer inflated our second-hand dinghy ...

Question:

You are a national news reporter. You have investigated events leading up to the rescue of the two men and have interviewed them to discover their views on what happened.

Write your newspaper report of the incident.

In your newspaper report you should comment on:

- details of the trip, where the men were going, what they were hoping to do and why
- how well-informed, prepared and equipped they were to undertake the trip
- the difficulties they faced, the circumstances of their rescue and their state of body and mind.

Base your newspaper report on what you have read in Passage A, but be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullet points.

Begin the newspaper report: ‘Earlier today, two men had to be airlifted to safety ...’

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Report model answer

Based on the above question, the following model answer is an example of a full-mark report response.



Your notes

The response starts with a newspaper report style introductory sentence, showing awareness of format

A fun fishing trip for two old friends who had not seen each other since university took an unexpected turn recently at White Cap River. The pair had not been fishing together for years, and were clearly hoping for a big catch, as well as a real-life adventure at the setting of one of the men's favourite childhood stories.

Leaving their families and responsibilities in the city, the friends decided to catch up over a long drive in a soft-top sports car through open countryside and rolling hills in the hope of creating new memories together. The mountain road famously offers impressive views of the valley below, before descending back down into the National Forest. The employee of a local fishing-tackle shop recalls meeting the pair when they stopped to check their directions and how far it was to the river itself. He was surprised that they were undertaking the journey to the canyon without a four-wheel drive vehicle, but did not see anything else at that point to give him cause for concern.

The response directly refers to details from the text, with appropriate development

The tone and register are appropriate for a newspaper report

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Your notes

Those familiar with the terrain would know it is unwise to attempt this particular descent without a suitable vehicle. There seemed to be a distinct lack of planning and preparation between the friends, who thought that - alongside a faded atlas that was probably out of date - just a rod and a reel was all that was going to be required. The passing of time meant that the friends did not seem to know each other as well as they thought, as it transpired that Royer, who was in charge of the wheel on the windy road that worms its way through forest land, has a phobia of heights. The narrow, crumbling road proved too much for him, and both men ended up spending that last of the daylight (and the last of their fuel) searching for a less dangerous route down to the river.

Each bullet point in the question is dealt with in a separate paragraph

The level of formality is appropriate for a newspaper report

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The following day, realising that he hadn't seen the men's car return, the fishing-tackle shop employee contacted the emergency services, fearing an accident. The gradient and the depth of the canyon means that, if stuck, it is impossible to get back up and get help. The mountain rescue team quickly assembled and, by the river, located the men, who had spent a cold and sleepless night in their car without blankets or food. Surprisingly to some observers, they were in the process of inflating a second-hand dinghy to try to attempt the foaming whitecaps of the river, which requires proper equipment and a decent boat even to try to fish in it. The men seemed undaunted by their ordeal and were ready to try again another day, but did accept that they would need to be better prepared next time.

The development uses logical inferences made from the details in the text

The development is based upon specific details from the text

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Unannotated model answer



Your notes

Model answer:

A fun fishing trip for two old friends who had not seen each other since university took an unexpected turn recently at White Cap River. The pair had not been fishing together for years, and were clearly hoping for a big catch, as well as a real-life adventure at the setting of one of the men's favourite childhood stories. Leaving their families and responsibilities in the city, the friends decided to catch up over a long drive in a soft-top sports car through open countryside and rolling hills in the hope of creating new memories together. The mountain road famously offers impressive views of the valley below, before descending back down into the National Forest. The employee of a local fishing-tackle shop recalls meeting the pair when they stopped to check their directions and how far it was to the river itself. He was surprised that they were undertaking the journey to the canyon without a four-wheel drive vehicle, but did not see anything else at that point to give him cause for concern.

Those familiar with the terrain would know it is unwise to attempt this particular descent without a suitable vehicle. There seemed to be a distinct lack of planning and preparation between the friends, who thought that – alongside a faded atlas that was probably out of date – just a rod and a reel was all that was going to be required. The passing of time meant that the friends did not seem to know each other as well as they thought, as it transpired that Royer, who was in charge of the wheel on the windy road that worms its way through forest land, has a phobia of heights. The narrow, crumbling road proved too much for him, and both men ended up spending that last of the daylight (and the last of their fuel) searching for a less dangerous route down to the river.

The following day, realising that he hadn't seen the men's car return, the fishing-tackle shop employee contacted the emergency services, fearing an accident. The gradient and the depth of the canyon means that, if stuck, it is impossible to get back up and get help. The mountain rescue team quickly assembled and, by the river, located the men, who had spent a cold and sleepless night in their car without blankets or food. Surprisingly to some observers, they were in the process of inflating a second-hand dinghy to try to attempt the foaming whitecaps of the river, which requires proper equipment and a decent boat even to try to fish in it. The men seemed undaunted by their ordeal and were ready to try again another day, but did accept that they would need to be better prepared next time.

Commentary:

- The response starts with a newspaper report style introductory sentence, showing awareness of format --- although the response does not explicitly start with the opening line given in the task instructions, the first sentence is appropriate to the form and demonstrates clear understanding of the task and text
- The response directly refers to details from the text, with appropriate development
- The tone and register are appropriate for a newspaper report
- Each bullet point in the question is dealt with in a separate paragraph
- The level of formality is appropriate for a newspaper report

- The response uses logical inferences made from details in the text
- The development is based upon specific details from the text



Examiner Tips and Tricks

The suggested word count for this task is a guide, and you are not penalised for writing under or over 250–350 words. However, writing too little can mean that your answer does not have enough development or detail. Writing too much can mean that you go off topic and lose focus, which again can be self-penalising. It is therefore a good idea to stick as closely as you can to the word count guidance.

Our model answers are not written in timed, exam conditions. We have therefore shown a range of points that could be included to answer this question, and provided a model you can use to help with the structure of your answer.

You can find further guidance on suggested word counts for CIE [here](#).

Summary

- Remember to read the question carefully and highlight:
 - The instructions (what you have to do)
 - The focus of each bullet point
- Re-read Text C and highlight the relevant information you can use in your answer
- Address each bullet point in order:
 - Make sure you cover all of the bullet points as equally as possible
 - Base all of your answer on the ideas and details you find in Text C
- Decide on the voice and style you want to create and maintain that in your answer
- Do not just repeat details of what happened:
 - You need to develop your ideas to demonstrate understanding



Your notes



Your notes

Question 3 Model Answer: Journal

Question 3 Model Answer: Journal

For this task, you will be asked to produce a piece of writing in a particular format, based on what you have read in Text C. You may be asked to write in one of six possible formats (genres):

- A letter
- A report
- A journal entry
- A speech
- An interview
- An article

The following guide will demonstrate how to answer Question 3 in the format of a **journal**. The task itself is taken from a past exam paper.

Text C and Question 3

The following example of Text C is about a travel specialist who goes on a cycling journey across the Andes mountain range in South America.



Your notes

Ariana Svenson works for [Apus Peru Adventure Travel Specialists](#), a company that offers you opportunities to visit little-known places. Here she writes about a cycling journey across the Andes Mountains in South America, through varied scenery.

OK. I admit it, we go looking for adventure. We had always wanted to visit the Manu region but it had seemed hopelessly expensive so we had the idea of cycling there, seeing Peru's National Bird, the Cock of the Rock, and then going home.

It was low season and although it was totally the wrong time of year to be crossing mountain passes, we set off, armed with an excess of wet weather gear, and brimming with enthusiasm. 5
Two minutes after we had reached the top of a mountain pass it was hailing and we were drenched.

Our descent would have been truly exhilarating in good conditions – when it's freezing it is hellish. Our hands, though gloved, were the first part to lose feeling – not good when you need to be able to feel your hands to apply the brakes on hairpin corners! Your lips go numb first, and 10
then your nose starts running and your knees begin to freeze up in the cold. It was pure agony. An Andean village, that appeared to be warmly welcoming from above, was coldly abandoned and shut up as we passed by closed doors.

About three hours later, bedraggled and miserable, we arrived at Colquepata. There they told us it was only another forty minutes downhill to Paucartambo: it took us over two hours! At least the 15
journey was downhill and at its best there were smooth roads, good gradients and high speeds. We passed through pretty farmland, groups of eucalyptus trees and herds of cattle and sheep on their way home at the end of the day.

Paucartambo emerged around the corner, a charming place, with cobblestone streets, narrow alleys and whitewashed houses. People in skirts and draped in colourful blankets added an old 20
world charm and we felt that we had stepped back centuries.

Later we arrived in San Pedro to see the Cock of the Rock birds doing their mating dance. We camped on a nice man's soccer pitch, and woke up at midnight to the sound of rain – incessant, heavy, continuous rain that pelted the tent with a somewhat dismaying regularity. We roused 25
ourselves and trudged through the muddy quagmire to see the Cocks' dance again, wondering how many would look for a mate in this foul weather. We were right – very few!

Following a flat tyre, brake adjustments and load rearrangements, we were jolting our way downhill again, through ever more beautiful and warm jungle. Soon we were racing along through pampas luxuriant with grasses – the rich moist air of the jungle filled our lungs which felt 30
as if they had been starved in the Andes. It was heady and intoxicating – and we just wanted to smile and laugh, out of sheer happiness. Great flocks of big, bright, buttercup-yellow butterflies were feeding on the road and when we passed they fluttered up and surrounded us, so we were cycling in a haze of butterflies – utterly dreamlike!

We continued to the village of Pilcopata where we managed to get some necessary repairs done to the bikes. We decided to travel further by local bus but had to wait because all the 35
buses out of the region were full, and there were no more for two days.



Your notes

In those long hours of waiting we developed the art of conversation with complete strangers. In our time-oriented society, it's not something that we usually do. Everyone is far too busy or has lots of friends. However, in the heat of the jungle people aren't in a hurry and are happy to discuss things with strangers. I got into a conversation with an old woman who had lived all her life in the region. She exclaimed, "Do you know how much tourists pay to visit Manu?" She added, without bitterness, "Not a cent reaches our town. They come with all the food they need – even bread and water! And all they leave is rubbish!" It struck me then just how important it is to buy locally, and be environmentally conscious in all our actions. I am glad that when we travel we buy at small shops and eat in local restaurants. You can't please everyone, but you can make a difference.

40

45

Question:

Imagine you are one of Ariana Svenson's companions on her journey. You are now on a boat on the way home and are writing your impressions of the adventure in your journal.

Write your journal entry in which you describe what you think were the good and bad points of your journey.

In your journal entry you should include:

- your thoughts and feelings
- what you have learnt from the experience.

You should base your ideas on what you have read in the passage, but do not copy from it.

You should write between 1 and 1½ sides, allowing for the size of your handwriting.

Question 3 journal model answer

Based on the above question, the following model answer is an example of a full-mark journal response.



Your notes

The answer starts clearly in the first person and demonstrates an awareness of the purpose of the task

As we are now well on our way home, I have time to sit and reflect on the adventure we had and what I've learnt from the experience. Despite the fact it was low season, we were all so excited to be cycling through what promised to be an incredible landscape, and we felt well prepared with all of our wet weather gear. I quickly realised that this trip was not going to be easy, as we had only just reached the top of a mountain pass when hailstones started falling! I normally love the thrill of a descent after a gruelling climb, but it was so cold I lost the feeling in my hands, which made it really hard to control the bike; the terrain turned into something truly terrifying. I cannot describe how relieved I felt when we finally entered Colquepata and we were told we were only 40 minutes downhill to Paucartambo. It wasn't 40 minutes; it was over two hours, but at least the roads were smooth and it started to feel fun. I began to get a sense of daily life in this part of Peru as we passed farmland and animals returning home at the end of the day. Paucartambo itself was so picturesque and I started to feel more excited again about what else we would get to see.

The response gives a clear and convincing account of the main features of the journey

It uses and develops several ideas, both factual and inferential, from the passage

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Your notes

The response clearly focuses on the writer's thoughts and feelings

That first day felt tough, especially with another downpour again at midnight and a flat tyre to deal with. However, my feelings totally changed as we progressed further into the warmth of the jungle. The heady scents and humid air were like a tonic to the high Andes climate, and the nature around us was just stunning; I don't think I will ever forget cycling in a haze of butterflies. It was like being in a cartoon, and this experience really made me appreciate the sublime beauty of nature.

A consistent narrative voice is maintained throughout

While I was a bit disappointed at first to find out we had to wait a couple of days for a bus out of Pilcopata, this turned out to be an unexpected bonus as it allowed us to really immerse ourselves in Peruvian life and talk to some of the locals. It really made me think about how we rush about all of the time at home, sticking to our schedules; we've probably lost the art of just having a conversation. Nobody is in a hurry in the heat of the jungle, and time makes people more open to talking. I was especially surprised to find out how little money from tourism actually reaches the people of the town. If I have taken anything from this journey, it is definitely to be more environmentally aware of the impact of our actions as tourists, and to buy local and eat local when travelling in order to put money directly back into the economy where it matters.

It picks up on the references to the understanding of a different way of life and the importance of preserving this and the surrounding environment

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Your notes

Despite some of the journey being astonishingly tough, and I don't think I have ever been so wet and utterly exhausted. I'm so glad I did it as I feel as though I have grown as a person, not only through working as part of a team, but also mentally and emotionally by learning more about a part of the world I had such little understanding of.

The response also demonstrates and develops suggestions about what the writer may have learnt from their journey

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Unannotated model answer

Model answer:

As we are now well on our way home, I have time to sit and reflect on the adventure we had and what I've learnt from the experience. Despite the fact it was low season, we were all so excited to be cycling through what promised to be an incredible landscape, and we felt well prepared with all of our wet weather gear. I quickly realised that this trip was not going to be easy, as we had only just reached the top of a mountain pass when hailstones started falling! I normally love the thrill of a descent after a gruelling climb, but it was so cold I lost the feeling in my hands, which made it really hard to control the bike; the terrain turned into something truly terrifying. I cannot describe how relieved I felt when we finally entered Colquepata and we were told we were only 40 minutes downhill to Paucartambo. It wasn't 40 minutes; it was over two hours, but at least the roads were smooth and it started to feel fun. I began to get a sense of daily life in this part of Peru as we passed farmland and animals returning home at the end of the day. Paucartambo itself was so picturesque and I started to feel more excited again about what else we would get to see.

That first day felt tough, especially with another downpour again at midnight and a flat tyre to deal with. However, my feelings totally changed as we progressed further into the warmth of the jungle. The heady scents and humid air were like a tonic to the high Andes climate, and the nature around us was just stunning; I don't think I will ever forget cycling in a haze of butterflies. It was like being in a cartoon, and this experience really made me appreciate the sublime beauty of nature.

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from this journey, it is definitely to be more environmentally aware of the impact of our actions as tourists, and to buy local and eat local when travelling in order to put money directly back into the economy where it matters.

Despite some of the journey being astonishingly tough, and I don't think I have ever been so wet and utterly exhausted. I'm so glad I did it as I feel as though I have grown as a person, not only through working as part of a team, but also mentally and emotionally by learning more about a part of the world I had such little understanding of.



Your notes

Commentary:

- The answer starts clearly in the first person and demonstrates an awareness of the purpose of the task
- The response gives a clear and convincing account of the main features of the journey
- It uses and develops several ideas, both factual and inferential, from the passage
- The response clearly focuses on the writer's thoughts and feelings
- A consistent narrative voice is maintained throughout
- It picks up on the references to the understanding of a different way of life and the importance of preserving this and the surrounding environment
- The response also demonstrates and develops suggestions about what the writer may have learnt from their journey

**Examiner Tips and Tricks**

The suggested word count for this task is a guide, and you are not penalised for writing under or over 250–350 words. However, writing too little can mean that your answer does not have enough development or detail. Writing too much can mean that you go off topic and lose focus, which again can be self-penalising. It is therefore a good idea to stick as closely as you can to the word count guidance.

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Summary

- Remember to read the question carefully and highlight:

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 - The focus of each bullet point
- Re-read Text C and highlight the relevant information you can use in your answer
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 - Make sure you cover all of the bullet points as equally as possible
 - Base all of your answer on the ideas and details you find in Text C
- Decide on the voice and style you want to create and maintain that in your answer
- Do not just repeat details of what happened:
 - You need to develop your ideas to demonstrate understanding



Your notes



Your notes

Question 3 Model Answer: Speech

Question 3 Model Answer: Speech

For this task, you will be asked to produce a piece of writing in a particular format, based on what you have read in Text C. You may be asked to write in one of six possible formats (genres):

- A letter
- A report
- A journal entry
- A speech
- An interview
- An article

The following guide will demonstrate how to answer Question 3 in the format of a **speech**. The task itself is taken from a past exam paper.

Text C and Question 3

The following example of Text C is about a journalist who has been invited to spend time at a base station in Antarctica.



Your notes

Text C: Base station, Antarctica

This text is taken from a longer narrative. The narrator is a journalist who has been invited to spend time at a national scientific programme base station on Antarctica. She has travelled by ship with a new group of staff arriving at the base at the start of summer and is planning to stay long enough to experience the beginning of winter.

Base emitted a hushed grandeur, as if a vault door had been closed – all noise guarded fiercely behind it. A gunshot-like crack echoed through the air – an iceberg rotating – then a roar like a distant waterfall as another chunk of the ice shelf collapsed into the bay. Rough squawks of skuas were magnified through the telescope of empty dry air. There were no smells of soil, trees, nor grass. Only the scent of Antarctica – like two stones rubbed together. Flint.

5

We passed truckloads of tinned-food boxes in huge hangars. In summer, Base could accommodate a hundred people: scientists returning from tented field-camps or being deployed to them, pilots flying them in and out, cooks, mechanics, even the occasional VIP.

10

We were shown the laboratory, air-traffic control tower, stores where ski equipment was repaired, generator hut and sewage treatment plant. It felt both exciting and daunting to call this home for the next few months. There were no museums, cafés or restaurants. No animals, Wi-Fi or children. No real strangers.

That evening we encountered more Base people – young, fit figures without that fume of the outside that still clung to us. They sported the same padded boiler suits and fleece jackets, and were keen to talk. 'I don't call the real world often, it's best to just live in the bubble,' confided marine biologist Ben. I said I planned to stay until the very last boat out. 'Winter here's long,' he added.

15



Field training took days; we learned how to abseil into a crevasse, get ourselves out and rescue someone who has fallen in. We hurled ourselves down the sheer face of a glacier – to learn to break our fall with an ice-axe. We erected and dismantled pyramid tents, cooked on camp-stoves, and learned how to load a sledge.	20
There wasn't much time to think, let alone write, in the early weeks occupied by briefings, obligatory group activities and trips into the bay to collect water samples.	25
Summer was term time. Each evening scientists gave informal lectures: scientists who routinely dived beneath the ice among carnivorous leopard seals and orcas; scientists in the ice-coring team who worked in an underground cavern, surfacing only to cook and sleep in pyramid tents on the blasted plain of Berkner Island. I was learning more in weeks than I had in entire years.	30
For the first time I began to think of the planet as an organism whose well-being I could affect. Here I felt closer to it. I could hear its pulse. 'In ice, depth equals time,' explained Xavier, a scientist working with the ice-coring team. 'The further down you go, the further back in time you go. The ice core shows that major changes have taken place within Earth's climate. There's an irrefutable steady upward trend, directly linked to carbon dioxide, and humans.' I shivered involuntarily.	35
As winter approached, activities on Base diminished. For entertainment, our dwindling group played cards or leafed through old magazines.	
We were given new instructions by Base Commander Simon. We weren't to walk off Base without telling him first. The sea ice was hardening at the shore; fresh snowfalls made it difficult to see where land stopped and sea began. We risked falling through.	40
Safety was taken seriously – endless rehearsals drilled into us how Antarctic tragedies had more than one cause; mishaps or misjudgements which sealed people's fate.	
Temperatures dropped further. Snowstorms blanketed the runway. The last ship out depended on the weather. People had overwintered unexpectedly here before.	45
Around us the world was hardening. In the bay it started as ice flowers, tiny crystal formations. The creeping carpet of flowers knitted together, until soaked by seawater it transformed into grey gruel, thickening into porridge. As temperatures plummeted, porridge-ice welded itself together, and sounded like steel grinding. In gathering darkness sea ice formed. The continent was closing in on itself, locking itself in. Winter was beginning.	50

Question:



Your notes

Question 3

You are Simon, the Base commander. You are giving a **speech** for a group of young people to explain to them the opportunities and challenges of living and working on the base station.

In your speech you should:

- explain the different kinds of jobs available at Base station and what activities each job might involve
- outline what they can expect day-to-day life to be like when they first arrive and once they have settled in
- suggest the challenges and rewards of living and working at the Antarctic base station.

Write the words of the speech.

Base your speech on what you have read in **Text C**, but be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullets points.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 10 marks for the quality of your writing.

Question 3 speech model answer

Based on the above question, the following model answer is an example of a full-mark speech response.



Your notes

Good morning everyone! My name is Simon and I'm a Base Commander in Antarctica. I'm here today to talk to you about the opportunities and challenges of living and working on a base station in such difficult conditions.

There are a range of different jobs available at the base station. You might be working as a scientist like Xavier, which can involve working with the ice-coring team or out in a field camp collecting samples. This is an important job because our scientists are conducting ground-breaking research into Earth's climate. We also have marine biologists who routinely dive with seals and orcas, so they tend to be the adventurous and brave ones! We need mechanics and engineers to keep the place running, as they look after things like the planes, generators, the sewage treatment plant or ski equipment. We have cooks who have to do interesting things with tinned food, as it is so difficult to get fresh supplies and there are a lot of people to feed. And, of course, we would all be stuck without the pilots transporting scientists to and from field camps. They do incredible work landing planes safely in what can be extremely challenging weather conditions.

The answer starts by demonstrating understanding of the format of the task (a speech) and what the task is about

Each bullet point in the question is dealt with in a separate paragraph

Direct references to the text are developed and expanded upon

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Your notes

So, if you decide that working at a base camp is for you, what can you expect when you first arrive and when you've settled in? Well, you'll be shown around first, and you'll notice that there are no cafes, restaurants or even Wi-Fi! There isn't much in the way of entertainment - just card games and magazines really. But don't worry: you'll be too busy to notice. To begin with, you will be involved in field training, where you'll learn to abseil into crevasses, get yourselves out and rescue someone who has fallen in. You will definitely be out of your comfort zone and fending for yourselves, putting up and taking down your own tents and cooking on camp-stoves. Then you'll be involved in regular briefings, group activities and trips to collect water samples. During the summer months, the scientists stationed at base camp give lectures, which are both informative and inspirational. It's great to get different perspectives and expert opinions on what we are studying. We also have more freedom to go for walks, but as winter approaches, we have to increase our safety rehearsals as accidents can easily happen in such a harsh environment.

The answer uses direct address to the audience, which is appropriate for a speech

All of the examples are taken from the text

The answer uses inference to develop points appropriately

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Your notes

There are definitely lots of challenges associated with living and working in Antarctica. You are a long way from civilisation, and although this can be a welcome break from the pressures of modern life, it can feel quite isolating, especially in the winter as there is a real danger of being stranded. The winter is long and hard, and although amazing, the animals that we share our home with can also be dangerous. There is also a real risk of feelings of depression or loneliness, with very few changes of personnel and not much leisure time. However, there are also lots of rewards. Living and working so closely with the same group of people for such a long time can help build long and lasting friendships and a sense of these people being family. The landscape is inspirational, and the experience of living in Antarctica really changes you as a person. And probably most importantly of all, living in this awe-inspiring place helps you to develop a real awareness of the health of our planet; we see how fragile the carpet of ice is and therefore appreciate the implications of global warming and the actions we must take to protect our world.

The answer sustains a confident "voice" throughout

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Unannotated model answer

Model answer:

Good morning everyone! My name is Simon and I'm a Base Commander in Antarctica. I'm here today to talk to you about the opportunities and challenges of living and working on a base station in such difficult conditions.

There are a range of different jobs available at the base station. You might be working as a scientist like Xavier, which can involve working with the ice-coring team or out in a field camp collecting samples. This is an important job because our scientists are conducting ground-breaking research into Earth's climate. We also have marine biologists who routinely dive with seals and orcas, so they tend to be the adventurous and brave ones! We need mechanics and engineers to keep the place running, as they look after things like the planes, generators, the sewage treatment plant or ski equipment. We have cooks who have to do interesting things with tinned food, as it is so difficult to get fresh supplies and there are a lot of people to feed. And, of course, we would all be stuck without the pilots transporting scientists to and from field camps. They do incredible work landing planes safely in what can be extremely challenging weather conditions.



Your notes

So, if you decide that working at a base camp is for you, what can you expect when you first arrive and when you've settled in? Well, you'll be shown around first, and you'll notice that there are no cafes, restaurants or even Wi-Fi! There isn't much in the way of entertainment – just card games and magazines really. But don't worry: you'll be too busy to notice. To begin with, you will be involved in field training, where you'll learn to abseil into crevasses, get yourselves out and rescue someone who has fallen in. You will definitely be out of your comfort zone and fending for yourselves, putting up and taking down your own tents and cooking on camp-stoves. Then you'll be involved in regular briefings, group activities and trips to collect water samples. During the summer months, the scientists stationed at base camp give lectures, which are both informative and inspirational. It's great to get different perspectives and expert opinions on what we are studying. We also have more freedom to go for walks, but as winter approaches, we have to increase our safety rehearsals as accidents can easily happen in such a harsh environment.

There are definitely lots of challenges associated with living and working in Antarctica. You are a long way from civilisation, and although this can be a welcome break from the pressures of modern life, it can feel quite isolating, especially in the winter as there is a real danger of being stranded. The winter is long and hard, and although amazing, the animals that we share our home with can also be dangerous. There is also a real risk of feelings of depression or loneliness, with very few changes of personnel and not much leisure time. However, there are also lots of rewards. Living and working so closely with the same group of people for such a long time can help build long and lasting friendships and a sense of these people being family. The landscape is inspirational, and the experience of living in Antarctica really changes you as a person. And probably most importantly of all, living in this awe-inspiring place helps you to develop a real awareness of the health of our planet; we see how fragile the carpet of ice is and therefore appreciate the implications of global warming and the actions we must take to protect our world.

Commentary:

- The answer starts by demonstrating understanding of the format of the task (a speech) and what the task is about
- Each bullet point in the question is dealt with in a separate paragraph
- Direct references to the text are developed and expanded upon
- The answer uses direct address to the audience, which is appropriate for a speech
- All of the examples are taken from the text
- The answer uses inference to develop points appropriately
- The answer sustains a confident “voice” throughout

**Examiner Tips and Tricks**



Your notes

The suggested word count for this task is a guide, and you are not penalised for writing under or over 250–350 words. However, writing too little can mean that your answer does not have enough development or detail. Writing too much can mean that you go off topic and lose focus, which again can be self-penalising. It is therefore a good idea to stick as closely as you can to the word count guidance.

Our model answers are not written in timed, exam conditions. We have therefore shown a range of points that could be included to answer this question, and provided a model you can use to help with the structure of your answer.

You can find further guidance on suggested word counts for CIE [here](#).

Summary

- Remember to read the question carefully and highlight:
 - The instructions (what you have to do)
 - The focus of each bullet point
- Re-read Text C and highlight the relevant information you can use in your answer
- Address each bullet point in order:
 - Make sure you cover all three of the bullet points as equally as possible
 - Base all of your answer on the ideas and details you find in Text C
- Decide on the voice and style you want to create and maintain that in your answer
- Do not just repeat details of what happened:
 - You need to develop your ideas to demonstrate understanding



Your notes

Question 3 Model Answer: Interview

Question 3 Model Answer: Interview

For this task, you will be asked to produce a piece of writing in a particular format, based on what you have read in Text C. You may be asked to write in one of six possible formats (genres):

- A letter
- A report
- A journal entry
- A speech
- An interview
- An article

The following guide will demonstrate how to answer Question 3 in the format of an **interview**.

Text C and Question 3

The following is Text C taken from a past exam paper. It is about a writer's experience of supporting her husband's training to compete in an extreme event.



Your notes

I tried to book a weekend camping but abandoned it. We would have spent the whole time fitting Sam's training around what we were doing, and it wasn't worth it. That year the kids didn't go camping at all. 20

My own freedom to run was curtailed. Saturdays became all about childcare. I only managed one Saturday trail-run with the girls from April onwards and that was thanks to wonderful friends who got up at 6.45 on a Saturday to watch my son. I got fed up with not being able to say yes to invitations. 25

We didn't do any family hiking for months. Sam justifiably didn't want to hike after exercising.

There was so much laundry ('different road conditions') so much extra food ('fuel') and so much gear (multiple pairs of goggles with different tints 'because you never know...')! Smiling understandingly, Sam assured me the next one will be cheaper. Next one? 30

'Because it's there,' I'd snarl to anyone who dared question why any sane mortal would tackle an Ironman. I enjoyed mercilessly shaming his less-than-supportive business partner into recognising the potentially boundless benefits of Sam's well-publicised adventure for their newly-established, fledgling travel company. A flurry of online articles described me as 'a runner married to a triathlete' – it took me a few moments to recognise our family and beam with immeasurable pride. 35

Our son missed having Dad around at the weekends, especially if he woke up after Sam had left to train on a Saturday when sometimes there were tears. But he got used to the different dynamic. He was given an 'Ironman' superhero toy as a birthday gift by some relatives and immediately started making it swim, bike and run! The poor child thinks that this is how normal families operate. 40

Having said all that, watching Sam emerge god-like from the water, power past us on his bike and rocket down the finishing chute, head held high as our kids cheered with the crowd – utterly incredible and intoxicating, one of life's rare pinnacles of perfection. It had been an epic journey for all of us. I'm so glad we did it. And next year? Well yes, it's my turn... 45

Question:



Your notes

Re-read **Text C**, *What it's like to be married to a future Ironman*, in the insert and then answer **Question 3** on this question paper.

Question 3

You are Sam. After completing the race you are interviewed for a podcast about your experience and the advice you would offer to anyone thinking of entering an Ironman.

The interviewer asks you three questions only:

- How exactly do you need to prepare for a challenge like Ironman **and** why is each aspect of that preparation important?
- How do you think preparing for Ironman affected other areas of your life **and** what advice would you offer anyone considering entering an Ironman for the first time?
- What were the rewards of completing an Ironman for you and your family?

Write the words of the interview.

Base your interview on what you have read in **Text C**, but be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullet points.

Begin your interview with the first question.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 10 marks for the quality of your writing.

Question 3 interview model answer

Based on the above question, the following model answer is an example of a full-mark, interview-style response:



Your notes

How exactly do you need to prepare for a challenge like Ironman and why is each aspect of that preparation important?

There are lots of elements involved in preparing for a challenge like Ironman. It is really important to dedicate a good amount of time to training. For this particular challenge, I started six months before the event, as there is such a lot to get organised: you need time to build up strength and stamina. For me, it was also essential to get a coach who was an expert in these kinds of challenges, and who could help me to develop monthly training plans in order to build up my fitness. It also helped that he could keep me on track and help me to stay motivated and focused. Because Ironman involves different types of physical challenges, you need to ensure that training involves bike rides, swims and runs, which also involves planning. I started on 1-3 hour bike rides initially, and then I was lucky as we had a pool near to where we live in which I could train for the swimming element. This was great because swimming was probably my weakest discipline initially. If you are not lucky enough to live near a pool, then this definitely needs to be considered as it is important that you are practising all of the disciplines, not just the one you find easiest. Finally, making sure you have the right kit is also essential, such as different pairs of goggles with different tints, so that you are prepared for different road and weather conditions and that you feel as comfortable as possible during the event.

The answer starts by addressing the first bullet point, in the "voice" of the character

The answer references specific details from the text

Direct references to the text are then developed and expanded upon

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Your notes

How do you think preparing for Ironman affected other areas of your life and what advice would you offer anyone considering entering an Ironman for the first time?

You definitely have to make sacrifices when training for this kind of event. I didn't get to spend much time with my family, and we missed out on things like our regular camping trips. I was very lucky to have such an understanding partner who supported me throughout my training. Initially it was a bonding experience, but as the preparation became more intense, I was more and more absent. So I would say be aware of this and try to train together or do things together for as long as you can. Lots of people questioned my decision to sacrifice so much for this challenge. My business partner in particular was less than supportive, and I did find it difficult to balance everything, but it helps if everyone is on the same page and if you are able to talk through any potential barriers. Yes, your social life will be affected, but it's not forever so don't let that put you off. But you do have to be aware of the financial implications of entering this kind of event, such as the cost of all the kit and other paraphernalia. So be realistic and consider what you really need.

The tone and choice of language is appropriate for an interview

The character's "voice" is confident and sustained

The bullet point asks what advice the character would give, so using direct address is appropriate here

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Your notes

What were the rewards of completing an Ironman for you and your family?

When I finished the event, I felt a massive sense of excitement and achievement. The crowd cheering really gave the finish line a sense of occasion, and the fact that my kids were there as well made it a special memory to cherish. My head was held high when I crossed the finish line, as I realised that I'd done it and it was all worth it. I feel as though I could be a bit of an inspiration for others, as my wife is planning on entering next year, and I think it shows a good example to my children of the power of physical and mental resilience and self-belief. And the publicity definitely helped to boost my new travel company's business!

The answer continues to reference specific detail from Text C

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Unannotated model answer

Model answer:

How exactly do you need to prepare for a challenge like Ironman and why is each aspect of that preparation important?

There are lots of elements involved in preparing for a challenge like Ironman. It is really important to dedicate a good amount of time to training. For this particular challenge, I started six months before the event, as there is such a lot to get organised: you need time to build up strength and stamina. For me, it was also essential to get a coach who was an expert in these kinds of challenges, and who could help me to develop monthly training plans in order to build up my fitness. It also helped that he could keep me on track and help me to stay motivated and focused. Because Ironman involves different types of physical challenges, you need to ensure that training involves bike rides, swims and runs, which also involves planning. I started on 1–3 hour bike rides initially, and then I was lucky as we had a pool near to where we live in which I could train for the swimming element. This was great because swimming was probably my weakest discipline initially. If you are not lucky enough to live near a pool, then this definitely needs to be considered as it is important that you are practising all of the disciplines, not just the one you find easiest. Finally, making sure you have the right kit is also essential, such as different pairs of goggles with different tints, so that you are prepared for different road and weather conditions and that you feel as comfortable as possible during the event.

How do you think preparing for Ironman affected other areas of your life and what advice would you offer anyone considering entering an Ironman for the first time?



Your notes

You definitely have to make sacrifices when training for this kind of event. I didn't get to spend much time with my family, and we missed out on things like our regular camping trips. I was very lucky to have such an understanding partner who supported me throughout my training. Initially it was a bonding experience, but as the preparation became more intense, I was more and more absent. So I would say be aware of this and try to train together or do things together for as long as you can. Lots of people questioned my decision to sacrifice so much for this challenge. My business partner in particular was less than supportive, and I did find it difficult to balance everything, but it helps if everyone is on the same page and if you are able to talk through any potential barriers. Yes, your social life will be affected, but it's not forever so don't let that put you off. But you do have to be aware of the financial implications of entering this kind of event, such as the cost of all the kit and other paraphernalia. So be realistic and consider what you really need.

What were the rewards of completing an Ironman for you and your family?

When I finished the event, I felt a massive sense of excitement and achievement. The crowd cheering really gave the finish line a sense of occasion, and the fact that my kids were there as well made it a special memory to cherish. My head was held high when I crossed the finish line, as I realised that I'd done it and it was all worth it. I feel as though I could be a bit of an inspiration for others, as my wife is planning on entering next year, and I think it shows a good example to my children of the power of physical and mental resilience and self-belief. And the publicity definitely helped to boost my new travel company's business!

Commentary:

- The answer starts by addressing the first bullet point, in the "voice" of the character
- The answer references specific details from the text
- Direct references to the text are then developed and expanded upon
- The tone and choice of language is appropriate for an interview
- The character's "voice" is confident and sustained
- The bullet point asks what advice the character would give, so using direct address is appropriate
- The answer continues to reference specific detail from Text C



Examiner Tips and Tricks

The suggested word count for this task is a guide, and you are not penalised for writing under or over 250–350 words. However, writing too little can mean that your answer does not have enough development or detail. Writing too much can mean that you go off topic and lose focus, which again

can be self-penalising. It is therefore a good idea to stick as closely as you can to the word count guidance.

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You can find further guidance on suggested word counts for CIE [here](#).



Your notes

Summary

- Remember to read the question carefully and highlight:
 - The instructions (what you have to do)
 - The focus of each bullet point
- Re-read Text C and highlight the relevant information you can use in your answer
- Address each bullet point in order:
 - Make sure you cover all three of the bullet points as equally as possible
 - Base all of your answer on the ideas and details you find in Text C
- Decide on the voice and style you want to create and maintain that in your answer
- Do not just repeat details of what happened:
 - You need to develop your ideas to demonstrate understanding



Your notes

Question 3 Model Answer: Article

Question 3 Model Answer: Article

For this task, you will be asked to produce a piece of writing in a particular format, based on what you have read in Text C. You may be asked to write in one of six possible formats (genres):

- A letter
- A report
- A journal entry
- A speech
- An interview
- An article

The following guide will demonstrate how to answer Question 3 in the format of an **article**. The task itself is taken from a past exam paper.

Text and question

The following text is about a drummer who has been invited to play with a jazz band at their next gig, which is at an open-air summer concert.

The narrator has successfully auditioned for the job of drummer in a small jazz band. He has been invited to play with the band at their next 'gig'. This concert will be the last of a series of open-air summer concerts in a local park. The existing members of this jazz band first played together in a bigger band after they had retired.

The dudes are severely elderly, these Nightblooming Jazzmen. They wear white belts and bow ties, trousers pulled up high.

'Our angle is we're old,' they say. 'You'll have to dress the part if you're going to be our pulse, drumbo.' A couple of them have serious moustaches. I paste one on for the gig, bleach my eyebrows and pop on a straw hat.

They have the coolest names: Clyde, Chet, Wally and Hal. When I say my name is Nathaniel, they say, 'You can't use a name like that.'

After my audition, Clyde comes over as I'm packing up my drums. Grinning, he says I've got the job, but from now on they'll call me Old Stanley.



Your notes

The gig's in a park. The bandstand is covered with graffiti. A crowd of old people and a few of their grandkids look on from folding chairs.

Clyde puffs 'Good afternoon' into the microphone and we're off and running. We cook up a carousel of sound with our hands, with the wind in our chests. A gang of senior citizens – and me – just tearing up the place. Chet is coaxing sad wah-wahs out of his trombone. Clyde noodles out golden lassos on the clarinet. Wally burps wetly along on the tuba. We stir up a flock of audience jazz-hands, playing music no one plays any more, stuff I learned from my dad. The sun tilts through the trees, spot-lighting shafts of dust. We're just a speck in the grand whirling scheme, but at least we're making noise. We close the set like landing a plane, bouncing along a little then rolling to a stop.

Give these guys their due – that gig was pretty sweet.

Hal, breathing heavily, comes over. 'Great job,' he says. 'You can swing. How'd you learn?'

'My dad,' I explain.

'Did he play?'

'Yeah.' That's all I say.

Hal talks more at the after-show party. 'We were a big band. Guys gradually dropped off though ...'

They tried rolling with it, calling themselves The Littlest Big-Band, but couldn't draw a crowd. So Clyde, who's basically the leader, said they'd play jazz – did anyone have a problem with that? One guy – the drummer – walked out.

'You're good kid,' Hal says patting me hard on the back, like he's burping a baby.



Your notes

The women organising the party have laid out a great spread: crackers, some kind of creamy dip, cheese, grapes and peanuts. I start attacking the snacks.

Hal says, 'Easy, Stanley.'

The women gather up and introduce themselves. They have candy-floss hair, neatly knitted cardigans and foggy eyes. There's more than one brooch and bracelets all around, so they jangle when they move. They deliver their names like they're performing a song. Ruth and Nancy are sisters. Betty is an old friend. Great names, I say. Crumbs fly from my mouth. Clyde gives me a look.

The women love our music. So many of the summer concerts are such disappointments, they say.

Ruth recalls a terrible rap act. They all shudder and look to me, expecting an opinion. 'Rap sucks,' I say reaching for more cheese.

'You have most unusual eyebrows,' Nancy says.

'Goes better with the moustache,' I say.

Everyone laughs because, at the moment, my silvery fringe moustache is curled up on the dashboard of my car.

'How's that for commitment?' Clyde smiles. 'The kid gets hired and goes the extra mile to fit in.'

I feel like I'm eight years old – a little kid with a whole army of grandparents.

The party chugs forward, with some of the guys playing their horns, Wally's stories of wars and Chet coming West to pick citrus.

They start dancing to records.

'Why don't you dance?' Wally asks, watching Chet dancing with Betty.

'I don't know how to dance to this music,' I say, making my excuses and leave.

Looking back from my car, I watch them, silhouettes jitterbugging, framed in the rosy window. The music's faint, but I tap along. They're laughing in waves, warbling harmonies. Why couldn't I have met them a long time ago? But they didn't exist then as they are now, I know. They look like a movie flashed on a wall, hanging in space with no connection to time. It seems impossible that I stepped out from it, or that I could get back in. It's like a soap bubble you try to put in your pocket.

The song ends. Everyone shouts, 'More!'

That's all I need to be called back. I press on the moustache.

Question:



Your notes

You are a journalist writing an article for a monthly music magazine. You were at the gig in the park, and at the party afterwards, and interviewed band members and some of their audience.

Write your magazine article.

In your magazine article, you should:

- explain who the band are, their style, and the history of the band
- describe the concert, audience reaction and the aftershow party
- introduce Stanley and consider how he fits in with the band.

Base your article on what you have read in Passage A, but be careful to use your own words. Address each of the three bullet points.

Begin your article: 'This month's featured concert ...'

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Article model answer

Based on the above question, the following model answer is an example of a full-mark article response.



Your notes

This month's featured concert was the last of a series of open-air performances at Sutton Park, featuring The Nightblooming Jazzmen, formerly The Littlest Big-Band. With the exception of their drummer, "Old Stanley", the Jazzmen are a group of retired musicians who have clearly been playing together for a long time and who are comfortable with each other. They are definitely a bunch of charmers, with their natty white belts, bow ties and serious moustaches. In an attempt to draw bigger audiences, the Jazzmen have made a stylistic move to jazz and swing, and the retro vibe clearly suits them. They also deserve a larger audience as they are clearly a bunch of skilled musicians. There are no magic tricks or backing tracks here; just a gang of senior(ish) citizens cooking up a stripped-back, honest and authentic sound with their instruments and voices, specialising in the type of music rarely heard nowadays, and here, the crowd lapped it up. Clyde, the lead vocalist, also plays clarinet, with Chet (a certified ladies' man) on trombone, Wally on tuba and Hal, the band leader, who definitely puts a lot of energy into his performance, given how out of breath he is by the end!

The answer uses the suggested sentence starter from the task instructions

The response directly refers to details from the text, with appropriate development

The tone and register are appropriate for an article written for a music magazine (sub-headings are not required for this kind of article)

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Your notes

Each bullet point in the task is dealt with in a separate paragraph

The venue was hardly grand: a graffiti-covered bandstand in the local park lent a dishevelled air to the event (a regular each summer), with the daytime crowd consisting mainly of the older generation, some accompanied unenthusiastically by their grandchildren as their grandparents tried to encourage the younger generation to enjoy this old-fashioned style of music. However, the audience were loyal and the talent of the Jazzmen clearly swayed everyone in their favour, as the reception was largely positive and the waving of jazz-hands grew more vigorous. Afterwards, as we munched on crackers, dip, grapes and peanuts provided by the Jazzmen's loyal groupies, the atmosphere was lively as Ruth, Nancy and Betty revealed a bit more about the lasting appeal of The Nightblooming Jazzmen. Ruth in particular recalls a previous concert featuring a rap artist with a shudder, and Clyde reveals that the women love their music, revelling in the sense of nostalgia it brings for their youth.

Details from the text are well integrated into the response

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Your notes

The first person perspective
• is appropriate for the
format of the task

As the records go on the jukebox and the jitterbugging starts, I grab Old Stanley (real name Nathaniel) to find out how he fits in with the rest of the band. He is definitely a lot younger than the rest of the band, sporting a false moustache and bleached eyebrows, but it's clear that he is making an effort to fit in, and the other band members appreciate it. His musical ability is obvious, and he reveals he learned his drumming skills from his father, himself once an accomplished jazz musician. While his manners might not be on a par with the others (I catch him talking with his mouth full), he obviously feels at home with the atmosphere and the style of music, with Hal especially taking him under his wing. If Stanley sticks with it and decides to follow in his father's footsteps, then this bodes well for a possible revival of interest in jazz and swing, and a larger following may follow. Given the quality of the sound, The Nightblooming Jazzmen certainly deserve it.

Development
• is not too
far-fetched

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Unannotated model answer

Model answer:

This month's featured concert was the last of a series of open-air performances at Sutton Park, featuring The Nightblooming Jazzmen, formerly The Littlest Big-Band. With the exception of their drummer, "Old Stanley", the Jazzmen are a group of retired musicians who have clearly been playing together for a long time and who are comfortable with each other. They are definitely a bunch of charmers, with their natty white belts, bow ties and serious moustaches. In an attempt to draw bigger audiences, the Jazzmen have made a stylistic move to jazz and swing, and the retro vibe clearly suits them. They also deserve a larger audience as they are clearly a bunch of skilled musicians. There are no magic tricks or backing tracks here; just a gang of senior(ish) citizens cooking up a stripped-back, honest and authentic sound with their instruments and voices, specialising in the type of music rarely heard nowadays, and here, the crowd lapped it up. Clyde, the lead vocalist, also plays clarinet, with Chet (a certified ladies' man) on trombone, Wally on tuba and Hal, the band leader, who definitely puts a lot of energy into his performance, given how out of breath he is by the end!

The venue was hardly grand: a graffiti-covered bandstand in the local park lent a dishevelled air to the event (a regular each summer), with the daytime crowd consisting mainly of the older generation, some



Your notes

accompanied unenthusiastically by their grandchildren as their grandparents tried to encourage the younger generation to enjoy this old-fashioned style of music. However, the audience were loyal and the talent of the Jazzmen clearly swayed everyone in their favour, as the reception was largely positive and the waving of jazz-hands grew more vigorous. Afterwards, as we munched on crackers, dip, grapes and peanuts provided by the Jazzmen's loyal groupies, the atmosphere was lively as Ruth, Nancy and Betty revealed a bit more about the lasting appeal of The Nightblooming Jazzmen. Ruth in particular recalls a previous concert featuring a rap artist with a shudder, and Clyde reveals that the women love their music, revelling in the sense of **nostalgia** it brings for their youth.

As the records go on the **jukebox** and the **jitterbugging** starts, I grab Old Stanley (real name Nathaniel) to find out how he fits in with the rest of the band. He is definitely a lot younger than the rest of the band, sporting a false moustache and bleached eyebrows, but it's clear that he is making an effort to fit in, and the other band members appreciate it. His musical ability is obvious, and he reveals he learned his drumming skills from his father, himself once an accomplished jazz musician. While his manners might not be on a par with the others (I catch him talking with his mouth full), he obviously feels at home with the atmosphere and the style of music, with Hal especially taking him under his wing. If Stanley sticks with it and decides to follow in his father's footsteps, then this bodes well for a possible revival of interest in jazz and swing, and a larger following may follow. Given the quality of the sound, The Nightblooming Jazzmen certainly deserve it.

Commentary:

- The answer uses the suggested sentence starter from the task instructions
- The response directly refers to details from the text, with appropriate development
- The tone and register are appropriate for an article written for a music magazine (sub-headings are not required for this kind of article)
- Each bullet point in the task is dealt with in a separate paragraph
- Details from the text are well integrated into the response
- The first person perspective is appropriate for the format of the task
- Development is not too far-fetched

**Examiner Tips and Tricks**

The suggested word count for this task is a guide, and you are not penalised for writing under or over 250–350 words. However, writing too little can mean that your answer does not have enough development or detail. Writing too much can mean that you go off topic and lose focus, which again can be self-penalising. It is therefore a good idea to stick as closely as you can to the word count guidance.

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Your notes

Summary

- Remember to read the question carefully and highlight:
 - The instructions (what you have to do)
 - The focus of each bullet point
- Re-read Text C and highlight the relevant information you can use in your answer
- Address each bullet point in order:
 - Make sure you cover all of the bullet points as equally as possible
 - Base all of your answer on the ideas and details you find in Text C
- Decide on the voice and style you want to create and maintain that in your answer
- Do not just repeat details of what happened:
 - You need to develop your ideas to demonstrate understanding